

configure how the desktop looks. The *Style* tab controls the visual appearance of the controls such as the buttons and menus. The second tab, called *Icons*, is about how the icons are shown, for example, in the panel, on the desktop, in the file manager and in the menus. Because I think the default font size is too big, I need to use the third tab, called *Fonts*, to select a smaller size. A more detailed explanation about this aspect can be found at <http://docs.xfce.org/xfce/xfce4-settings/appearance>

- I use the *Background* option only to change the default background, and the *Icons* tab to select a smaller font size and to select the default icons for the visualisation on the desktop.
- The *Screensaver*, as its name suggests, is about selecting a screen saver. The option 'Blank after' is to set the time, in minutes, after which the screen saver activates.
- The only thing that I did with the *Window manager* option was to select a smaller font size for the window's title. More information about this can be found at <http://docs.xfce.org/xfce/xfwm4/preferences>
- The Firewall configuration starts *Gufw*, if previously installed. This is a GUI for the Linux default firewall. Simply, change the *Status* to 'On'.
- In the *Login* window, you can choose the theme for it. My preference was 'Elegance', though you can also change its default background, which is located in `/usr/share/mdm/themes/Elegance/background.jpg` with another picture having the same name.
- Usually, it's not necessary to use the *Session* and *Startup* options. Sometimes, these can be used to uncheck some applications that will be started automatically when you log in to the desktop — for example, 'Bluemian', 'MintUpdate', 'mintUpload', 'mintWelcome', etc.
- The installation of a printer is easy. On *System > Printers* simply click on 'Add' and follow the instructions on the screen. The most important thing is that the recommended driver may not be the best. So some further tests may be needed.

Software manager

In this section, I would like to explain the applications I added after the default installation:

- *Accessories* group: mc (Midnight Commander), vim-gtk.
- *Graphics* group: eog also known as the Eye of GNOME (because it's not possible to print a picture from the default Ristretto application), Imagemagick (a nice application especially for batch operations) and Inkscape.
- *Internet* group: Skype.
- *Multimedia* group: Audacious (but the default Banshee is also a nice player), k3b (probably the best CD burner available on Linux), system settings (KDE system settings - by selecting *Application appearance > Icons > Mint-X-Aqua* you can have k3b with Xfce icons), mtp-tools, mtpfs, gmtp (gMTP is a player that can communicate with

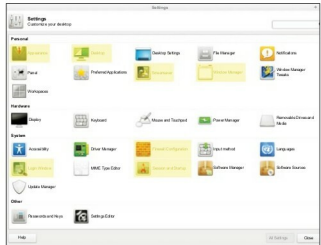


Figure 1: Settings manager

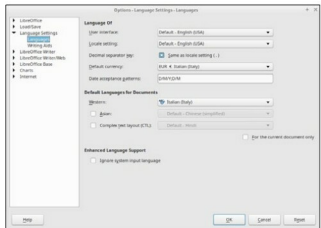


Figure 2: LibreOffice language settings

devices such as MP3 players or mobile phones via a USB cable — see Reference 2).

- *Office* group: qpdfview (a fast PDF reader), libreoffice-style-tango (I'm not a big fan of the default human icons), hyphen-[your-language], mythes-[your-language], myspell-[your-language] (the default language is selected during the installation process and if 'English' is chosen, it may be necessary to add one or more languages to LibreOffice; an example is shown in Figure 2).
- *Settings* group: gufw (see the previous section).
- *Other packages*: efax, fonts-inconsolata, fonts-sil-gentium-basic, p7zip-ttf, ttf-mscorefonts, texlive-full. Some information about 7-Zip and efax will be presented in the next two sections.

7-Zip

This software is very useful to zip (with encryption) one or more files. In the following example, an encrypted file called *archive.zip* containing two text files is created. The syntax for the terminal is as follows: